



Mechatronic Sensors Trainer

Fundamental Labs – Joysticks and Potentiometers

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Mechatronic Sensors Trainer – Application Guide

Joystick and Potentiometer Lab

Why Explore Joysticks and Potentiometers?

Potentiometers measure the angle of a dial or the position of a slider. Potentiometers give users an intuitive way to manually adjust inputs in applications that require fine tuning and adjustments, such as volume knobs, light dimmers, and temperature dials. Joysticks, which use multiple potentiometers to measure direction, are used in a variety of controllers for video games, aircraft control, and assistive technology.

Background

This lab is part of the Fundamentals labs for the Mechatronic Sensors Trainer. These labs will guide you through the sensors that are part of the board and the ones that are provided as external sensors so you can understand how to read from the sensors, what they read, when they are used, and you feel comfortable using them. This will also include highlighting datasheets to learn how to interpret them and know what to look for.

Prior to starting this lab, please review the following concept review (located in Documents/Quanser/4_concept_reviews/),

- 4_concept_reviews/Mechatronics/**012_potentiometers**

Getting Started

In this lab, you will use the **Sensors Trainer** to learn about the basics of the **Potentiometers and Joysticks**. The lab will guide you through the working principle of potentiometers, how to read and use them to better understand how joysticks function, as well as using the datasheet to understand the sensor better.

Before you begin this lab, ensure that the following criteria are met:

- Make sure you have the provided potentiometer, with the appropriate connectors for the Sensors Trainer
- Make sure the Sensors Trainer has been setup and tested. See the [Quick Start Guide \(Quanser/2_quick_start_guides/sensors_trainer\)](#) for details on this step.
- You are familiar with the basics of the programming language you are using for this lab.
- Have your development environment ready,
 - o If using Python, we recommend using Visual Studio Code.

Commented [LG1]: This might need a rewording once we figure out what those 'appropriate connectors' are